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Illiana Antique Power Association

Time to Reflect and Look Ahead

Illiana Members,

2025 brought with it some real challenges for Illiana: some good, and some not-so-good!

The early part of the year was spent refreshing the grounds with new signs and painting several of our little buildings. Before the 2026 show, we hope to paint the last of the buildings and replace and make more new signs. It just gives a feeling of a bright future when we see bright fresh paint and also that we have a plan to keep moving ahead!

The new speaker system was installed in early spring which made a huge difference in informing people about what was happening at the show. Now, no area of the grounds goes without sound and announcements can be heard over the entire grounds.

radio and TV ads, as well as more social media contacts. Prior to the show, a couple of interviews were done for radio both in Indiana and Illinois. Using the community calendars on TV and radio stations has awakened them to our being out here in Warren County, resulting in a news interview and spot on the local TV station for Christmas in the Village. Many people were hearing about us for the first time!

Early in 2025, we started the intense investigation of what we really had for insurance coverage, as many questions had been raised about the amount of coverage we actually had, resulting in an in-depth review. Several adjustments have been made to make sure we have the best possible coverage for our type of enterprise. Along with this came the need for signing liability release forms for many of the show participants. This was a new requirement to navigate for the first time, which seems to have gone well with maybe making some adjustments for the future years. This practice has been done by other organizations for many years for the same reason: insurance coverage and demand.

Our summer show was going very well till the storms and rain changed our plans! Friday was one of the best days ever for a Friday, but that came to a halt for the rest of the show with the arrival of severe storms. With this also came a new challenge of where to seek shelter on the grounds for an event like this. Big thanks to Warren County Emergency Management for helping us navigate this plan. They also provided us with 2-way radios to use for the weekend when we need to relate weather bulletins to one another. It will do us good to develop a plan for such events and have them posted in our show book; this can be accomplished with the help of Warren County Emergency Management.

Indiana Fairs and Festivals had their festival bus on the grounds for Friday and participated in the parade on Friday afternoon. This bus travels all over the state of Indiana all year long promoting the fairs and festivals of the state. In 2026, we will have an ad on the side of the bus advertising our show in July. They also gave us some very positive comments: 1. We are one of the most shaded grounds in the state for a show with all of our big trees, 2. we are a very friendly group welcoming new people and new ideas, and 3. our signage was excellent for finding the grounds. We look forward to working with them again in 2026 when their bus will again be on the grounds.

Our biggest challenge for 2026 is to present a “wow” factor for our show to really draw in a big crowd; we want people to realize we are here and have been for the last 40+ years. If you have an idea for this, please feel free to make suggestions to

Your help is always appreciated!

The Saturday evening entertainment was a big hit with the group of people who came back to the grounds after the storm and those who stayed to hear some great music. Looks like we will be seeing Coop & Company again in 2026!

Christmas in the Village was a huge hit this year with the added ambiance of a good covering of snow, something that hasn't happened in many years. The crowd was excellent and you know they are having a good time when you see the kids running, playing in the snow, and even sitting in the snow eating their chili! And of course, the big hit for the kids is always Santa; he was kept busy both nights hearing about all those requests.

A new thing we have initiated this year is adding a wish list to our website and giving people ideas for ways they can help Illiana to keep going and maintain our grounds and show. It is still in early stages and we always look for ways that any and all members can help or contribute to make it a fun experience for all of us. If you have ideas for the wish list or wish to help out in any way, feel free to contact a board member or our president. We need your help, *always*!

Looking ahead to 2026, one of our main goals is to construct a permanent foundation and a shelter for the big Fairbanks engine. Hopefully, it can be big enough to house other engines that Illiana owns that can be displayed for all visitors to see and hear them run. We will be aggressively looking for funding for this project in the new year.

As always, we welcome any help with keeping the grounds maintained and all our operations moving smoothly. The summer show is our biggest need for volunteer help, so let a board member know when you're available and what your area of interest or expertise would be to help us out. You are appreciated!

In 2026, we also have the 250th birthday of our country, the celebration being called "America 250". We need to figure out ways to incorporate this into our summer show especially. If you are a member of one of our smaller groups within Illiana, be thinking about how your group can add this to your activities for the show and carry out America 250's celebration.

Let's all work together to make 2026 a Happy, Healthy, and Prosperous New Year for Illiana and also for each of us in our daily lives and in our families.

Facebook Website

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